

allow you to pay less in taxes during your working years, accelerating progress toward FI. Once you achieve FI, you can further decrease your tax burden and possibly eliminate income tax entirely. This combination can allow you to cut back or stop working completely. Are you starting to get interested in tax planning?

Brad

What I love about FI is that it leads you to think differently and challenge all your assumptions. This is especially true when it comes to taxes! My wife and I are both CPAs, so we have a solid understanding of taxation, but the many benefits of looking at optimizing your taxes through a FI lens weren't even obvious to us!

We need to lay some groundwork before we dive deeper into the stories and strategies of *The Mad Fientist* and others in the FI community. If you cringe at the thought of taxes and feel this topic is too complicated, bear with me. I was once like you. This is a topic that deserves your attention and understanding. It really is less complicated than you may imagine. Let's start with a few basics.